

Joshua Gorton

GAME DESIGNER / PROGRAMMER

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PROFILE

UK-based gameplay programmer and recent University of Greenwich graduate specialising in Unity, Unreal Engine and C# scripting. Lead Programmer on Whoever Left the Light On, a surreal POV puzzle game shipped to Steam, where I led a team of four programmers within a twelve-person studio. I enjoy the full development process, from early physical prototyping through to analysing user-testing telemetry and optimising final builds. I thrive in collaborative environments and love solving problems to give players a great gameplay experience.

SKILLS

Engines Unity, Unreal Engine

Languages C#, Blueprint visual scripting

Disciplines Gameplay programming, systems design, procedural generation, AI and flocking behaviour, shader programming, physics-based mechanics, level design

Practice Team leadership, technical documentation, Git and pull-request workflow, user testing and telemetry analysis, studio production

SELECTED PROJECTS

Whoever Left the Light On - Lead Programmer

2026

Micro Studio · University of Greenwich · Releasing 30 Sep 2026 on Steam

- Led a team of 4 programmers within a 12-person studio, shipping the game to Steam.
- Designed core game systems and authored the project's technical documentation.
- Managed team organisation and workflow across the full production cycle.
- Delivery: 872 commits, 16,691 lines of code, 251 pull requests merged, 53 bugs filed and closed.
- A POV surreal puzzle game where dream logic replaces the rules you know.

Dissertation - Procedural Generation Research

2026

Solo research project · University of Greenwich

- Can Generated Points of Interest Intuitively Communicate Resource Affordances to Players?
- Built a Unity survival game where players sail between procedurally generated islands, each hiding one of three resources.
- Tested whether an island's generated appearance – shape, colour, terrain and props – could intuitively signal its resource without explicit markers.
- Designed and ran a 32-participant study against a colour-coded control group, then analysed the results.

Guns On Ice - Solo Project

2025

Object-Oriented Programming module · Released on itch.io

- Built recoil-based physics and sliding movement mechanics in Unity, fleshed out into a full arcade game.
- Sole developer: all programming and gameplay systems.

Day in the Life of a Carrot Farmer - Team Project

2024

University of Greenwich · Released on itch.io

- First joint university project, built in a team of three.
- Built the player movement and camera, the player interaction system, and the power-up system.

CapSize - Board Game, Team of Four

Game Jam

Physical hex-tile prototype

- Contributed to systems design and prototyping, and helped shape the wager/risk mechanics.
- Chance-based dice rolls and event cards balancing luck against player risk appetite; 30–45 minute sessions.

The Castle 2D - Solo Project

College

First finished game

- Branching corridors, sword combat, hidden power-ups, mini-bosses and a final boss.
- Environmental storytelling with no dialogue.

TECHNICAL DEMOS

Black Hole Shader (Unreal Engine) - real-time gravitational lensing and light distortion, built with Blueprint scripting and mathematics.

Hole in the Wall (Unity) - a flocking-AI simulation where 2D boid agents steer themselves into position to pass through an aperture in an advancing wall.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Games Design and Development (Programming) - 2:1

2026

University of Greenwich

BTEC Extended Diploma in Games Design - D*/D*/D

North Kent College, Dartford

BTEC Creative Media - Distinction

2021

Longfield Academy

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Sous Chef

- Several years leading and working within a fast-paced professional kitchen.
- Developed team leadership, composure under pressure, and coordinating people to tight deadlines – all of which carry directly into studio production.

INTERESTS

PC building and hardware, Chelsea FC, and an avid Elden Ring player.